



Northstar Analytics Business Expense Reimbursement Policy

Requirements for authorized reasonable documented and timely business expenses

Policy owner	Finance	Version	1.0
Effective date	September 26 2026	Applies to	Employees and approved workers

1 Purpose and Scope

Northstar Analytics reimburses reasonable and necessary expenses incurred for authorized company business. This policy applies to employees and other workers whom Northstar has approved to incur reimbursable expenses. It does not govern vendor invoices or expenses paid directly under procurement contracts.

No worker is expected to personally absorb an authorized business expense where reimbursement is required by this policy or applicable law. Expenses must have a clear business purpose, comply with budgets and client requirements, and be supported by accurate and timely documentation.

2 General Requirements

- **Business purpose.** The expense must directly support assigned work, an approved event, client service, training, recruiting, or another legitimate Northstar activity.
- **Reasonable cost.** Choose practical options and avoid unnecessary upgrades, premium services, duplicate charges, or expenses that appear excessive for the location and circumstances.
- **Advance approval.** Obtain required manager, budget-owner, Finance, client, or project approval before committing funds.
- **Accurate records.** Submit the actual expense, business purpose, date, amount, attendees or beneficiaries when relevant, project or client code, approvals, and required receipt.
- **No double recovery.** Do not seek reimbursement for an expense paid by Northstar, a client, another employer, insurance, a vendor credit, or another source.

3 Preapproval

Written preapproval is required for airfare, lodging, conferences, professional memberships, training, technology or equipment, coworking space, relocation-related costs, client entertainment, and any unusual or high-cost purchase. The approver must confirm business need, available budget, applicable client rules, and whether Northstar should purchase the item directly.

Employees may incur ordinary low-cost expenses within an approved project or team budget without separate approval when the manager has clearly delegated that authority. Splitting a purchase to avoid an approval threshold is prohibited. Approval does not guarantee reimbursement when the final expense violates this policy or materially differs from the approved request.

4 Reimbursable Expense Categories

- **Travel.** Approved transportation, lodging, baggage, ground transit, parking, tolls, and other necessary travel costs under the Business Travel and Expense Procedure.
- **Meals.** Reasonable meals during approved overnight travel and approved business meals with a documented business purpose and attendees.
- **Supplies and services.** Necessary office supplies, shipping, printing, software, communications, and professional services that were approved and not reasonably available through Northstar.
- **Development and memberships.** Approved training, conferences, certifications, licenses, and professional memberships related to the employee's role.
- **Remote work.** Required remote-work costs only when approved in advance or required by applicable law.

5 Travel Lodging and Transportation

Travel must be approved before booking and arranged through designated channels when available. Book economy or coach airfare and reasonably priced lodging near the work location. Premium cabins, luxury lodging, upgrades, lounges, companion costs, leisure extensions, and change fees caused by personal preference are not reimbursable without a documented exception.

Use public transit, rideshare, taxi, rental vehicle, or personal vehicle based on safety, total cost, and business need. Personal-vehicle mileage is reimbursed at the current company rate for approved business miles, excluding ordinary commuting. Mileage reimbursement covers fuel, maintenance, and depreciation; parking and tolls may be claimed separately. Traffic, parking, and moving violations are personal expenses.

6 Meals Entertainment and Alcohol

Northstar reimburses actual reasonable meal costs rather than a per diem unless Finance approves another method. Itemized receipts and the names or business relationship of attendees are required for business meals. Tips should reflect local practice. Alcohol is reimbursable only for an approved client, recruiting, or company event and must be moderate, lawful, and separately identifiable; individual alcohol purchases are personal expenses.

Entertainment must have a documented business purpose, receive advance approval, and comply with client gift, ethics, and anti-bribery restrictions. Expenses for government officials, candidates, political organizations, or other sensitive recipients require Legal approval before any commitment.

7 Nonreimbursable Expenses

- **Personal costs.** Personal travel, companions, childcare, pet care, personal grooming, clothing, entertainment, minibar purchases, and other expenses unrelated to company business.
- **Commuting and home costs.** Ordinary travel between home and the regular work location, routine internet or utilities, and home furnishings unless approved or legally required.
- **Penalties and misconduct.** Fines, citations, late fees caused by the traveler, illegal purchases, policy violations, and losses resulting from negligence or misuse.
- **Unapproved upgrades or equipment.** Premium travel, room upgrades, personal devices, furniture, software, subscriptions, or services purchased without required approval.
- **Cash equivalents and donations.** Gift cards, cash gifts, charitable or political contributions, and personal rewards purchases unless specifically authorized for a business program.

8 Documentation and Submission Deadlines

Submit expenses through the approved expense system within 30 calendar days after the expense or completion of travel, and sooner when required by law, a client contract, a corporate-card cycle, or Finance instructions. Itemized receipts are required for lodging and airfare and for any expense of 25 dollars or more; Finance may require receipts for smaller amounts.

If a receipt is unavailable, provide proof of payment, vendor, date, items purchased, amount, business purpose, and a signed missing-receipt statement. Repeated missing receipts may be denied. Personal information unrelated to the business purpose should be redacted without obscuring required transaction details.

9 Review and Approval Procedure

Step	Required action
1 Employee submission	Enter each expense, business purpose, project or client code, required attendees, approvals, and itemized receipt within the deadline.
2 Manager review	Confirm business necessity, reasonableness, policy compliance, budget, client rules, and accurate coding; return incomplete items.
3 Finance review	Validate documentation, duplicate claims, tax treatment, payment method, and exceptions; request clarification or adjust unsupported amounts.
4 Reimbursement	Pay approved expenses through payroll or accounts payable according to the normal processing schedule and applicable law.
5 Record retention	Maintain the expense report, receipts, approvals, and audit history in the designated system under the Records Retention Policy.

10 Corporate Cards Advances and Foreign Currency

Corporate cards may be used only by the assigned cardholder for authorized business expenses. Personal charges are prohibited and must be repaid immediately if made accidentally. Cardholders must submit receipts and reconcile transactions on time; Northstar may suspend or cancel a card for late, unsupported, or improper use.

Cash advances require Finance approval and prompt reconciliation; unused funds must be returned. Foreign-currency expenses should use the card statement conversion or the documented exchange rate on the transaction date. Do not add a separate currency fee already included in the converted charge.

11 Late Disputed and Taxable Expenses

Late reports may delay payment and may be denied when Northstar cannot verify the expense, charge a client, or comply with accounting and tax requirements, except where reimbursement is required by law. Employees should raise disputed reductions or denials with the manager and Finance promptly. Certain reimbursements may be treated as taxable income when documentation or timing does not meet applicable tax rules.

12 Exceptions Compliance and Repayment

Exceptions require a documented business reason and written approval from the budget owner and Finance before the expense when practical. Northstar may recover duplicate, personal, unsupported, or improperly reimbursed amounts through repayment or another lawful method. Falsification, intentional misuse, or concealment may result in loss of purchasing privileges and corrective action, up to and including separation or legal action.

Northstar prohibits retaliation for good-faith reporting of expense fraud, accounting concerns, wage-and-hour issues, or legal violations. Concerns may be reported to a manager, Finance, People Operations, or Legal.

13 Roles and Related Documents

Employees are responsible for prudent spending and complete claims; managers and budget owners approve business need and coding; Finance administers reimbursement, cards, tax treatment, audits, and exceptions. Related documents include the Employee Handbook; Business Travel and Expense Procedure; Remote and Hybrid Work Policy; International Remote Work Policy; Company Equipment Lifecycle Policy and Procedures; Records Retention Policy; and Workplace Concern and HR Case Procedure.